

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · COUNTRY SERIES

CANADA
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Canada's family courts and child-welfare system.

65

CANADA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 128
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 26 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 13, 2026

REGIONS REPRESENTED
24

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

CANADA AT A GLANCE.

Across 65 Canada families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST	WENT PRO SE
128	**$362,000**	**26**	**64.6%**
65 of 65 families reported child counts	median across 35 families reporting 3+ categories	of parenting time	42 of 65 who answered; 38 of 65 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	REGIONS REPRESENTED
65	2.0	65 of 65	24

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Canada families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

02 THE COST OF CANADA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	45	$60,000	$138,180	$6,218,100
Lost Wages	40	$75,000	$143,825	$5,753,000
Other Court Fees	19	$12,000	$30,979	$588,600
Therapy / Evaluations	25	$10,000	$21,712	$542,800
Reunification Services	15	$2,500	$5,780	$86,700
GAL Fees	5	$10,000	$16,000	$80,000
Asset Loss	29	$200,000	$205,517	$5,960,000
Median Family Burden (35 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	**$362,000**	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



03 WHO IS REPORTING · CANADA

Most families documenting in Canada are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	33	51%
Case closed: within last 2 years	9	14%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	8	12%
Not in court but still affected	6	9%
Active case: progress being made	5	8%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	46	71%
Family Court Only	16	25%
CPS Only	3	5%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

5 – 10 years	16	25%
1 – 3 years	15	23%
Over 10 years	14	22%
3 – 5 years	14	22%
6 months – 1 year	6	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only	18	28%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	16	25%
50/50 Joint	15	23%
Full Custody	12	18%
Children in Foster Care	3	5%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP REGIONS

Ontario	20	31%
Alberta	11	17%
Nova Scotia	6	9%
Bc	4	6%
Saskatchewan	3	5%
British Columbia	3	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	21	32%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	20	31%
High Conflict Divorce	12	18%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)	6	9%
Other	5	8%

04 PARENT VOICES — CANADA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Canada comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *The system stole my childhood and then it took my adult life from me and my ability to be a mother because they didn't raise me properly according to their own file notes from my 17 years in their captivity. This has been a life sentence that never seems to end and they use only [...]*
>
> — KELLY BELINDA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Estranged me (the mother) from my kids who were legally kidnapped to the other side of the country in Canada in 2020. Severe CPTSD. My kids all developed depression, insomnia, anxiety and behavioural issues. I have been battling a serious illness (breast cancer) since 2018 with [...]

— CANADA PARENT · JACKIE

MORE VOICES FROM CANADA

Family court and CPS has destroyed my life and traumatized my children. Post separation abuse continues and is unrelenting.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The police and CPS protect the abusers. My children live in fear.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They destroyed my children. My daughter's depression is so bad, we're lucky she's still here.

— TERRI

The Crown (HIS MAJESTY THE KING/HER MAJESTY THE QUEEN) controls all family courts worldwide through the attorneys who are all accredited by the BAR and they have destroyed my relationship with my children. This entire system is run by narcissists and is fed by them too.

— STELLA

Left me devastated and destroyed ripped my heart out took away. Any faith I have left in the system allowed my abuser to abuse me further and harm my child with no accountability.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed my children and I. Everything has been lost because of the system that should have been there to protect us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They system has handed my ex full reigns, carte Blanche to use our children to continue his abuse.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have lost everything I worked all my 40 years to build. Nothing can be more traumatizing and catastrophic than losing a child to her abuser and knowing every day I cannot reach her. I have been disappeared by the system whose responsibility it was to protect my baby and I. She [...]

— MELANIE

All of the abuse I faced was denied. The control I was under was denied. I lost my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system continues to allow abuse which continues to deeply affect my kids and I.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has weaponized false allegations and has piled trauma on top of trauma. We will never be the same.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My oldest daughter told me my husband was molesting her and my youngest daughter. Police and the Durham Children's Aid Society refused to allow me to take my children for any medical exams. My husband said I was delusional. The Durham Children's Aid Society gave him full custody [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am no longer allowed to be what I lived for, I was robbed of my motherhood. The damage family court has done to my children is heartbreaking.

— ROBIN

Tear it apart, destroy my childrens upbringing, allowed them to learn that lying gets you what you want and theres no consequences.

— AMANDA

Broke mother and dimmed three childrens lights spirits and souls causing severe distrust and perpetual fear of abuser

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Ruined my marriage..my family..and stole my 3 children from me with the help of others they may have paid or threatened*
>
> — KEN

Let the abusers get away with what ever they want. Breach all court orders with no conciquences in Canada. We have no contact and no relationship with the child. The girlfriend is looking to adopt the child soon.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

devastation 19 years of abuse with no end in sight never thought i would be separated from my children they still love me but are puppets on strings performing for the EX. OVer 80 court hearings, judges not following rules, unfair process 28 different judges smear campaign No [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system I've dealt with Toronto and Newmarket has done nothing but traumatized myself and my child. There is no best interest of the child. There is only the best interest of the abusive father.. it has been eight years of battling for my child. The system has [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It be is not just the women who get the short end of the stick. False accusations, lies stealing it runs both ways and the man can loose big time

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed me as a human, completely shattered me in every way you can think. I really hate waking up most days as it feels like an endless nightmare. My daughter is my world and I'm being told she doesn't want to see me. We were best friends.

— BRITTANY

Making your child lie and hate is not love... it's abuse

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We are not the same people we were before this happened. The system tore through our family, traumatized our children, and left us carrying pain that words honestly cannot fully explain.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court and CPS system is a complete joke. No one does what they're supposed to do and by no stretch of the imagination is any of it what's best for the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *CFS has caused me and my daughter sever psychological harm and trauma that will take years to recover from and rebuild the damage they caused emotionally, financially, mentally, physically, psychologically and it broke me and my child in ways I didn't know you could break a [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has failed me. From private lawyers to Legal Aid. I have now lived seperated from my kids for 2 years due to lack of proper filings and hearings.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Perpetuating the physical, emotional, psychological, and financial abuse as well as continuing to traumatize myself and my daughters by forcing us to be with our abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've lost my oldest son for 4 years (19), I lost my daughter for 2 years. While he had my kids he was molesting my daughter. I had no contact and wasn't allowed to see them. He has turned my son completely against us and used him in his criminal trial as a character witness.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system in ON destroyed our family for 3.5 years when one of our children got sick and we were vulnerable. Instead of help for our sick child, we were prosecuted by CAP Nolan from McMaster and CAS Waterloo. There is no accountability, no fact checking, no obligation to [...]

— BARBORA

Cost me a parent child relationship and 9 months of time

— CODY

A web of lies , an group of manipulative spiders to weave it. Have left our home in shambles. My daughters shouldn't only see eachother for 48 hours .

— MEAGHAN

Family court reform is desperately needed. There's no governing body to control judges and their unlawful decisions against "the best interest of the child". Ask the judge to define "best interest of the child" in court so you can appeal their unlawful decisions.

— SARAH

It was a tough battle and still is

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *I experienced domestic violence and was told that I had to get an emergency parenting order to protect my children or I would lose them. I believed that the family court system would help my family, including their dad, to resolve what was going on and have a healthy, normal [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Clowns in gowns are appointing bought and paid for , anything for a buck , pretend alienation gurus

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has caused irreparable damage to many lives.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has forced me to co-parent with the same man who was jailed for abusing me, allowing the abuse and coercive control to continue long after separation. It has cost me my peace, my mental health, my financial stability, and years of my life fighting to [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has caused my children to lose trust in social workers and other people that are meant to keep them safe and listen to their needs and wants.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They guys all need to be held accountable for what the kids and the parents have go go threw Never lose your voice its the most powerful thing you have dont let them silence you For now they may have silenced my kids but I have recordings of my boys telling me what happened not [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has infantilized me, damaged my reputation and credibility, stolen my professional capacity, time, energy and massive resources that would otherwise be invested in our children. Family court has failed to secure the best interests of our children through the lack of [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Without evidence, I was removed from my children's lives, costing us irreplaceable years and causing profound emotional harm. The damage to our family is something we will carry for life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The judge keeps saying they care about my son yet postpone depite the evidence I submit of my credibiity and the harm this is causing my son. How can one abusive parent take away everything the other parent worked for and the system keeps reaarfimg hkm while I lost my home, my [...]

— AMY

49 Canada parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 44 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — CANADA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Canada families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> Estranged me (the mother) from my kids who were legally kidnapped to the other side of the country in Canada in 2020. Severe CPTSD. My kids all developed depression, insomnia, anxiety and behavioural issues. I have been battling a serious illness (breast cancer) since 2018 with a second occurrence that happened this past October. Severe poverty, loss, destitution, loss of civil liberties (the government suspended my drivers licence because I couldn't pay outrageous child support- my parents had to drive me to chemotherapy and life-saving medical appointments). My income is long term disability and I get $2150/month. My court order for child support is over $600/month. He won't let it go. I'm in arrears of over $40,000. It's still being tallied up by the month. Any income and credits from GST or other government rebates get garnished and automatically go to him. Severe financial and economic post-separation abuse. Evidence of physical and all other abuse during marriage which I presented to the courts was blatantly ignored & swept under the rug. He remarried and the income between him and his spouse is at least $350,000/year. They tried to bury me alive and still are. Fraud, maliciousness. Contempt of court. Not providing his tax returns for the last 5 years. In the same week I found out I had survived my first occurrence with breast cancer, the ex threatened me with a mobility application to move my kids cross-country. They gave him everything, I lost everything because I was too weak to represent myself and couldn't afford a lawyer. Legal Aid in my province is filled with incompetence and negligence - nobody would help me. In fact, the lawyers from legal aid took
>
> — JACKIE (1/2)

> advantage of my vulnerabilities and purposely dragged me, one for an entire year, she did absolutely nothing but gave me false hope. It's really unbelievable and sadistic. I have literally paid with my life and my kids lives because I made the choice to get married. Alberta Canada is festering with some of the most corrupt judges in the Western world. What happened to me and is still happening is absolutely criminal.
>
> — JACKIE (2/2)

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system stole my childhood and then it took my adult life from me and my ability to be a mother because they didn't raise me properly according to their own file notes from my 17 years in their captivity. This has been a life sentence that never seems to end and they use only stuff from my childhood against me as they have zero access to my current re words or Information and I will not provide them a thing or sign a thing for them. My oldest daughter is an addict and not well in life thanks to child protection, the police and the famiky courts and my son has been traumatized by their visits and I am retramatized everytime they bother us since the day he was born... this is not a sytem that protects families, it destroys them generation to generation making a profit off the stealing and selling of children. I had my child taken from me over marijuana growing alligations never proven in court and today weed is legal and parents smoke it I. Front of their kids at parks ad all over as if its a normal thing.... funny how things once bad are now deemed good.... I have no abuse or neglect or any other violations against me just the fact I was a foster child who had a really awful childhood.... thats my onky downfall in this life according to child protectins own records. Sad how many lives where ruined by this broken sytem and that it continues to my son 10 years later and to current day another 10 years later.... My Birth Name was Bonnie Belinda Niemi until I was 8 years old in 1993 I was abused and forced to change my name for an adoption that wouldnt even last 4 years. Before they returned me because I wasn't conforming to their way of life with me as the maid and their

— KELLY BELINDA (1/2)

2 sons as golden children. The system is sick but what's sick to me are social workers using text books to define what each family should look like while their foster homes are hell holes... I currently live next to a child protection foater hime for 3 years now as they moved into my semi detached home and the substance use of this woman and her children is appauling ne her mind all the other ongoings that turn my stomach daily.....

— KELLY BELINDA (2/2)

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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devastation 19 years of abuse with no end in sight never thought i would be separated from my children they still love me but are puppets on strings performing for the EX. OVer 80 court hearings, judges not following rules, unfair process 28 different judges smear campaign No justice cant get out of the broken system. so isolating no one outside the system can comprehend the night mare. i cannot work on disability and it continues to consume my life & resources

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system I've dealt with Toronto and Newmarket has done nothing but traumatized myself and my child. There is no best interest of the child. There is only the best interest of the abusive father.. it has been eight years of battling for my child. The system has failed myself and my daughter, both victims of domestic violence.. the people that were put in place to keep us safe are the most dangerous, including her father. We all speak about mental health, except when it has to do with a child or mother in the atrocity the crime against children in family court, and crimes against victims of domestic violence. Parental alienation for abusers is a very dangerous tactic that other court abusers in court actors go along with all for profit.. They're only solution for supposed alienation is to extremely and severely alienate the mother who is protecting her child.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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It was a tough battle and still is

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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The judge keeps saying they care about my son yet postpone depite the evidence I submit of my credibiity and the harm this is causing my son. How can one abusive parent take away everything the other parent worked for and the system keeps reaarfimg hkm while I lost my home, my money, my job, my belongings and my relationship with my son. This system is a JOKE!! They reward abusive parents because it is an abusive narcissistic system.

— AMY

Trafficking chidrens...

— : SOPHIE :

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have severe PTSD with physical symptoms that are debilitating. Where I was fully functional as a parent taking care of myself as a single mom for over 10 years, I now have difficulty caring for myself. My children were given no explanation as to why I disappeared. My daughter is being actively molested and everybody's ignoring her and my claims even though this man is practically a stranger. My claims of a threat to my safety were verified by police reports and charges laid after I was attacked and the children's Aid are completely ignoring this even though the reason for apprehension was my paranoia and fear of being attacked.

— CHASTITY

The very same system that is to protect children and families is the very system that continously made the choice to (The Provincal family Court System (Grande Prairie, Ab Canada) destroy the lives of three innocent children and there mother. If we (the children and i)have to serve a life sentence then so should they.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We wanted a family, planned, cared for, amazing support systems. Told the truth, never strayed from it, staying united. Trusted the systems that are to help, when they are not there to help, only burden for profit. Costs us money, but nothing compares to the loss of time we could of had with our child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It cost me everything a reputation being my child's life in future together. Full, custody that only protected us from the father. My reputation. Safety a future forever vulnerable. My ability to speak without fear. My child's mental health. As he is not okay in the father's care. My son was happy and healthy until the greedy father came in and helped take everything from us. Me and my child are the only ones that don't seem to matter.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

49 full approved Canada comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Canada report comes from Canada respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Canada — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 65 Canada families reporting here are not the universe of Canada families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

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